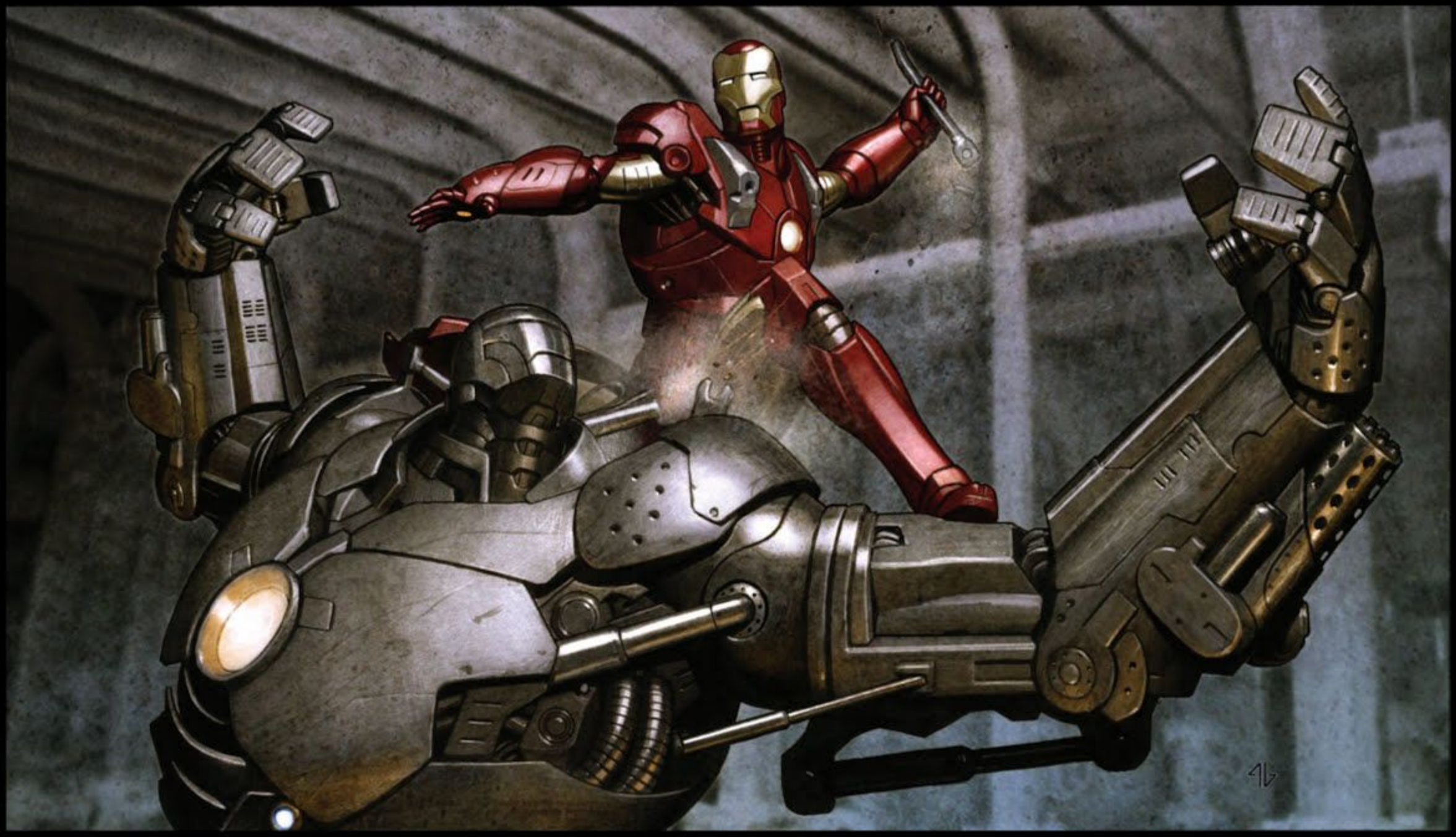


Above: Final battle keyframe art (Adi Granov)

Adi Granov's relationship with Iron Man began in 2004, when he turned in a series of evocative covers for the monthly comic title. Even for a character as steeped in high-technology and forward thinking as Iron Man, Granov's work was singularly futuristic, with eye-popping armor textures that made fans drool. Marvel knew they had something special in the synergy of Granov and Iron Man, and they overhauled the title and gave him the spotlight as regular artist. The resultant six-issue story arc — "Extremis," written by Warren Ellis — highlighted the sci-fi elements of the character, which the sci-fi leaning Granov found very appealing. Little did he know that the work he had done on "Extremis" had filtered to the Iron Man film's production crew, and would so inspire the illustrating team tasked with coming up with concept art and keyframe illustrations.